

COMPETITION COMMISSION

MAKING UP FOR LOST TIME

Ravneet Kaur, the new CCI Chairperson, is swiftly getting the regulator into shape and working on setting up a digital markets unit

BY SURABHI

► **AFTER LANGUISHING WITHOUT** a chief for seven months, the Competition Commission of India (CCI) is back to work at full tilt. Ravneet Kaur, the new CCI Chairperson, who took over in late May, has her priorities set out clearly, and taking up pending cases is just one of them.

“My key priorities include addressing pending cases related to antitrust and anti-profiteering and expediting new regulations so as to operationalise the amendments undertaken in the Competition Act recently,” Kaur tells *Business Today*.

“Timely enforcement, including investigation and adjudication, and taking effective steps for advocacy is a priority area,” she says, adding that organising the eighth BRICS International Competition Conference in October is also a priority.

Since it became operational in 2009, the CCI has sought to promote competition in markets, protect consumer interests, and ensure freedom of trade. Its functions include not just clearing large-scale mergers and transactions and regulating anti-competitive practices but also anti-profiteering under the goods and services tax (GST), as well as advocacy, research, and international co-operation.

In fact, Kaur highlights another priority for her—collaboration with international competition authorities and organisations for sharing best practices, fostering cooperation in cross-border cases, and showcasing the CCI’s work.

Kaur, a 1988 batch officer of the Indian Administrative Service from the Punjab cadre, took charge as the CCI’s Chairperson on May 23. Before that, the CCI worked with just two members for nearly seven months, and many activities were impacted or put on hold because of a lack of quorum. The CCI can consist of the Chairperson and up to six members. Quorum requires at least three members.

